

The Bridge: Facilitating Constructive Dialogue

JACKET GROUP

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AGENDA



LEARNING OBJECTIVES

**By the end of
this session, you
will be able to**



1

Identify the four elements of an effective succession dialogue using the Structured Dialogue Framework (SDF), also known as the S.T.A.R. model (Setting, Tone, Approach, Resolution).

2

Apply active listening and inquiry techniques to navigate emotionally charged leadership transition conversations.

3

Examine the positive aspects of having difficult conversations in the workplace and how it creates a healthier work environment

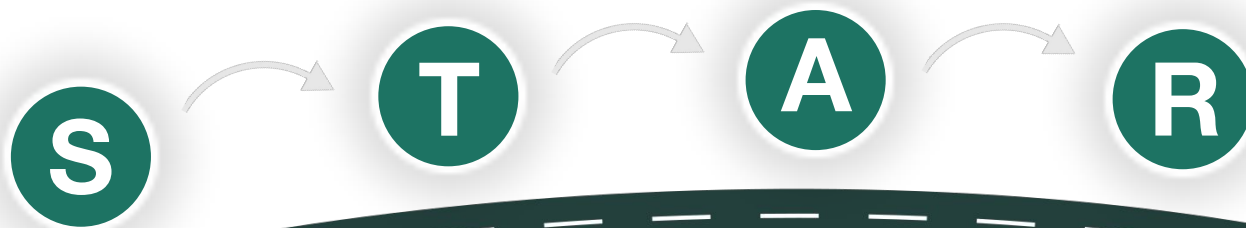


WHY THIS MATTER TO YOU

Quick reflection with Mentimeter

- ❑ Go to <https://www.menti.com/>
- ❑ Enter the code: **9938 6985**





Structure Dialogue Framework

Step	Key Question	Emotional Cue	Practical Tip
S – Setting the Stage	“What do I want to achieve from this conversation?”	Calm readiness	Choose the right time and place; clarify the purpose and tone at the start.
T – Tone of Respect	“How can I show appreciation while being honest?”	Empathy	Begin with gratitude; recognize past contributions before discussing change.
A – Approach with Inquiry	“What do I need to understand before offering my view?”	Curiosity	Ask open-ended questions; listen actively; avoid assumptions.
R – Resolution Orientation	“What is one next step we can both agree on?”	Collaboration	Summarize shared points and agree on next actions before ending.

PRACTICAL EXERCISE

Applying STAR model and active listening in difficult conversations



► Groups: 3 People (Breakout Zoom)

Participant One: Initiating Difficult Conversation

Participant Two: Other side of the Difficult Conversation

Inquirer: Objective Observer (Takes Notes & Active Listening)

► Timeline (9 Minutes Total)

1 min: Prep & Review Scenario

5 min: Practice Exercise

3 min: Group Debrief (Led by Facilitator)

► Debrief Questions (in group)

What felt most challenging when applying the framework?

Which part of the S.T.A.R. process felt most natural or most forced?

What other factors go into having a difficult conversation?



GROUP DEBRIEF

Midwest
Bottling
Est. 1947

Reflection (External)

Does Anyone Want to Share what they Answered:

- ☐ What felt most challenging when applying the framework?
- ☐ Which part of the S.T.A.R. process felt most natural or most forced?
- ☐ What other factors go into having a difficult conversation?

Next Step

- ☐ Complete the "Difficult Talk Planner Worksheet."
- ☐ Use this worksheet to prepare for the conversation you have been avoiding.



Reflection (internal)

Think about a difficult conversation you have been avoiding at work - consider what we have learned today and the benefits of having that conversation!

What did we learn?

► Use S.T.A.R. to Structure Dialogue

The S.T.A.R. framework (Setting, Tone, Approach, Resolution) is a powerful tool for planning and guiding difficult conversations.

► Inquiry is More Powerful than Assertion

Applying active listening and asking open-ended questions helps you navigate emotions and avoid assumptions.

► Difficult Conversations Create Healthier Teams

Avoiding conflict is not a long-term solution. Having these conversations benefits you and the business.

QUESTIONS?

Thank you for engaging in this dialogue with us.

~ JACKET Group

